



DIRECTORATE UPDATE · STRATEGIC INITIATIVES AND BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT

GRDA Advances Multi-Agency Framework for Tema Port–Rail Freight Integration

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The Strategic Initiatives and Business Development Directorate has led the development of a Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) governing the cross-docking of containers between the Tema Port–Kpone Unit Terminal and the Ashaiman Railway Terminal, a key milestone in the resumption of rail freight haulage along the corridor connecting Ghana's premier port to inland destinations.

The SOP was developed through a series of daily technical working sessions convened by a multi-agency Technical Committee comprising the Ghana Railway Development Authority (GRDA), the Ghana Ports and Harbours Authority (GPHA), the Ghana Revenue Authority (Customs Division), the Marine, Ports and Railways Police, and MES Logistics. The sessions included joint site inspections at the Tema Railhead and Ashaiman Railway Terminal to assess operational readiness on the ground.

The framework establishes clear protocols covering:

- Terminal operations and container handling between Tema Railhead and Ashaiman
- Customs bonding and clearance procedures at both terminals
- Gate access control and perimeter security (ISPS-compliant)
- Scheduling and standing radio communication between Railhead and Ashaiman ahead of every train movement
- Roles and responsibilities across all five partner agencies
- Pricing, KPIs, and escalation procedures

The SOP was formally adopted at a General Meeting following its review and endorsement by the Technical Committee, and lays the operational groundwork for the pilot phase of cross-docking operations expected to move an initial volume of window containers on a roughly 20-minute rail journey between the two terminals. The pilot is planned to coincide with the commissioning of new locomotives and a live operational demonstration.

This initiative forms part of GRDA's wider decongestion agenda for the Port of Tema, and reflects the Authority's continued commitment to cross-agency collaboration in unlocking rail as a safe, efficient, and commercially viable freight alternative.

Partner Agencies

Agency	Role
GRDA	Lead agency- rail operations and corridor commercialization
GPHA	Port and terminal operations, container origination
GRA (Customs Division)	Bonding, clearance, and regulatory compliance
Marine, Ports and Railways Police	Perimeter security and law enforcement



GHANA RAILWAY DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY

Agency	Role
MES Logistics	Logistics support and terminal coordination

For more information on GRDA's business development initiatives, contact the Strategic Initiatives and Business Development Directorate.